

Google Alert!

1 According to industry analysts, when did sales of digital cameras surpass sales of film cameras?



- a) In January 2006
- b) Around June 2005
- c) Around January 2004
- d) In 2001

2 What can MSN Virtual Earth do that Google Earth can't?

- a) It shows defence establishments in even greater detail
- b) It can pinpoint your location using Wi-Fi
- c) It shows the current cloud cover over a region
- d) It can tell you where Osama is

3 Why is a virus called a virus?

- a) Because it can replicate just like biological viruses
- b) Because it "infects" computers
- c) "Virus" is derived from "viroso," which means "harmful" in Italian
- d) It stands for "Virtually Ruins Ur System"

4 According to a recent CNN.com poll, what was the most significant development in the history of the WWW?

- a) Webcams and photo sharing
- b) Skype

c) Hotmail d) Google

5 What is the "Deep Web"?

- a) Adult and gambling sites
- b) Sites not indexed by regular search engines
- c) The set of Web pages with a black background
- d) Hyperlinks that can only be reached after traversing hundreds of them

6 What is Quaero?

- a) The new name of Cairo
- b) A new optoelectronic chipset being developed by Intel
- c) An advanced search engine being designed in Europe
- d) The Latin word for "computer"

7 A site called ThePlaceForItAll is selling tablet Macs. What is the hard disk size and RAM?

- a) 120 GB, 128 MB c) 80 GB, 512 MB
- b) 172 GB, 128 MB d) 40 GB, 512 MB

8 What's been the complaint about the recently launched Intel-based Macs?

- a) They crash even more often than Windows 98 did
- b) They are astronomically priced at \$6,200 (Rs 2,80,000)
- c) There have been no complaints: in fact, they're faster than their predecessors
- d) They ship with no software

9 Microsoft's Xbox 360 has most recently been in the news for...

- a) Contemplating using Blu-ray
- b) Refusing to use Blu-ray drives
- c) MS having been sued for not controlling adult content
- d) MS having been sued for incorporating parental controls

10 What has nanotechnology *not* produced?

- a) A guitar on the scale of 1 micron
- b) A cure for smelly socks
- c) Metal rubber
- d) A cure for bad breath

A "nibble" is the term, now hardly used, for four bits, or half a byte.

Quantum computers will work on the principle of branching out into many universes, with one computation being carried out in each universe.

Did You Know?

Got an interesting question? Send it in with the answer to tq@thinkdigit.com Mark "TQ" in the subject area.

Answers

1. c) January 2004	7. d) 40 GB, 512 MB
2. b) Wi-Fi locating	8. c) No complaints
3. a) It can replicate	9. a) and b) are both true
4. d) Google	10. d) A cure for bad breath
5. d) Sites not indexed	
6. c) A search engine	

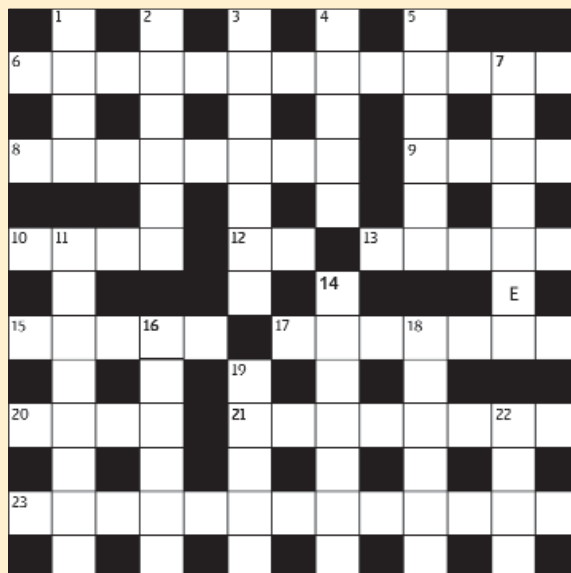
Crossword

ACROSS

- 6. Price scanner(7,6)
- 8. WinNuke (4,4)
- 9. International Data Encryption Algorithm(abbr)(4)
- 10. Telephone tapping machines(4)
- 12. Short for decibel(2)
- 13. Software programme that performs a service(5)
- 15. Adaptive Differential Pulse-Code Modulation(abbr)(5)
- 17. Microsoft's multimedia encyclopedia(7)
- 20. Short for Any Transport over MPLS(4)
- 21. Sample shareware or HTML Assistant Pro?(8)
- 23. Known as 'tunneling' in networking(13)

DOWN

- 1. E---- sending messages on the net(4)
- 2. ----code or password(6)
- 3. Google text based advertising system(7)
- 4. Short for broadband(abbr)(5)
- 5. Sending message over a facsimile machine(6)
- 7. Wireless telephony continuously connected to the web(7)
- 11. Changing of data to present day and time(8)
- 14. Put a programme onto a computer system(7)
- 16. Common Random Access Memory(abbr)(6)
- 18. Unit of electrical power(6)



- 19. Category of objects(5)
- 22. System base(4)

Send in your answers to the crossword with your complete contact details to TQ@thinkdigit.com on or before February 15. One lucky participant will win **Machine Nature**

By Moshe Sipper
Published by Tata McGraw-Hill



Win!

January 2006 Solution



Sumit Ghosh of Gujarat wins the prize for the January 2006 crossword

Crossword by Nitta Jaggi